

Daily Market Summary

July 28, 2026

No US trading session on 2026-07-29. Figures are from the last session (2026-07-28).

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: **+0.06** → **Neutral**

Trend (5-day EMA): **-0.03** → **Neutral** — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	+0.05
News headlines	20%	+0.01
Reddit (disabled)	0%	-0.13
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	+0.25

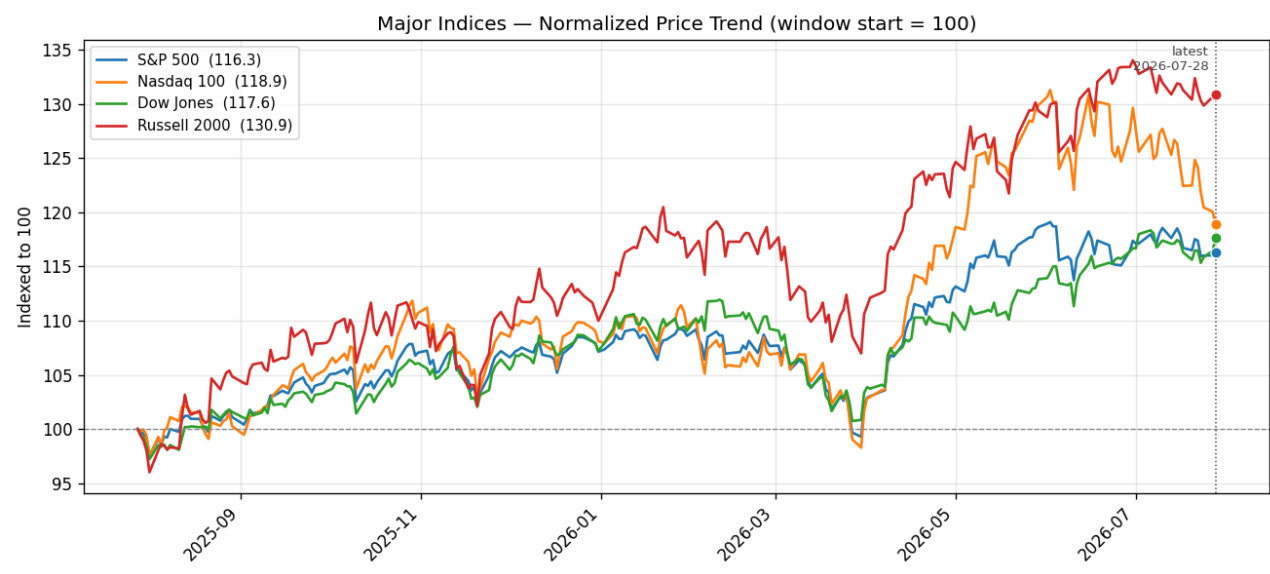
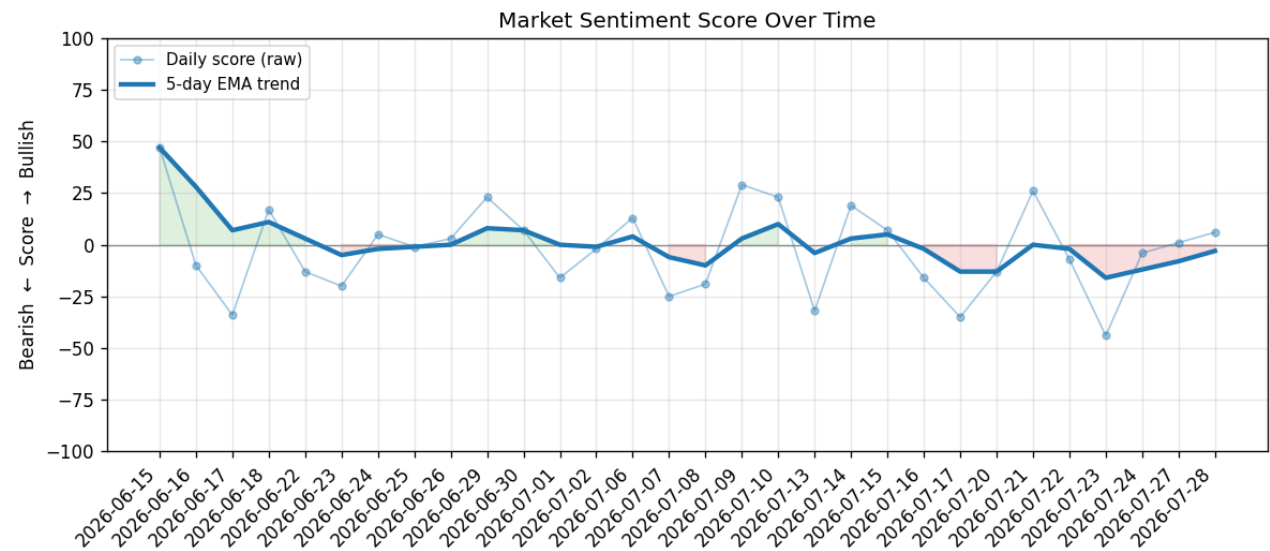
Equities rose with Nasdaq -1.0%, S&P 500 +0.2%, VIX -2.5%. Sector breadth: 7/11 sectors up. 10Y yield -0.8%. News headlines read neutral. Fed-policy expectations eased (13-Week T-Bill Yield -3.7bp). Today's overall market tone: Neutral.
(news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.92) — Seagate's earnings are welcome news for the battered AI trade

Most bearish (-0.96) — Micron's stock sinks toward worst monthly drop in 11 years as China fears escalate

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
Pharma / Healthcare	+2.14%	+1.93% vs S&P	100%	Slightly Bearish	Bullish (+0.81)
Consumer	+1.87%	+1.66% vs S&P	69%	Slightly Bearish	Bullish (+0.68)
SaaS	+0.29%	+1.27% vs Nasdaq	67%	Neutral	Slightly Bullish (+0.28)
Banking	-0.08%	-0.29% vs S&P	62%	Neutral	Neutral (+0.10)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	-0.08%	+0.90% vs Nasdaq	7%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.31)
Semiconductors / Compute	-4.38%	-3.40% vs Nasdaq	10%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.87)
Networking / Interconnect	-7.09%	-6.11% vs Nasdaq	7%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.89)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	-8.69%	-7.71% vs Nasdaq	0%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.91)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
Banking	1.82	0.0%	-0.07%	Neutral — quiet session
SaaS	0.98	5.4%	+0.29%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Pharma / Healthcare	0.86	1.8%	+2.14%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	0.81	5.7%	-8.69%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.71	1.7%	-0.08%	Neutral — quiet session
Semiconductors / Compute	0.59	2.4%	-4.39%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Consumer	0.54	2.0%	+1.87%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable

Networking / Interconnect	0.53	4.3%	-7.09%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
All tracked	0.70	2.4%	-0.15%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable

Bloomberg News Summary

Massive Day for Earnings as Fed Decision Looms | The Close 7/28/2026 (aired 2026-07-28) · Full-transcript summary · [watch on YouTube](#)

Key takeaways

- **Nasdaq 100 flirts with correction territory**, down ~9.5% from all-time highs, as chip stocks enter bear market with Philadelphia Semiconductor Index down 4.5% for fourth consecutive session
- **Hyperscaler AI spending under scrutiny** as investors question ROI on massive capex; credit default swap spreads widening on tech names, though companies maintain strong balance sheets and cash flows
- **Fed decision looms** with 30% probability of rate hike tomorrow, rising to 60-70% for September meeting; Kevin Warsh faces credibility test in only his second FOMC meeting as Chair
- **Market rotation accelerates** with equal-weight S&P 500 up 1.1% versus cap-weighted up just 0.2%, as investors shift from mega-cap tech to health care, consumer staples, and industrials
- **Major earnings beat from consumer bellwethers**: Ford raised full-year guidance on strong SUV margins; Visa shows resilient spending despite 7% workforce reduction; Coca-Cola up 5% on raised outlook

Guest views

- **Aswath Damodaran** (NYU Stern): Hyperscalers collectively overinvested in AI infrastructure with no clarity on products or buyers; smaller data center companies face real credit danger, not the hyperscalers themselves
- **Carol Tomé** (UPS CEO): Company achieving margin expansion through automation (68.5% of volume through automated facilities) and strategic shift toward health care logistics growing faster than 6% market rate
- **Christina Hooper** (Man Group): Low probability of Fed hike tomorrow but hawkish hold likely; tech companies face valuation re-rating as insurance companies drop AI liability coverage, creating governance crisis
- **Jon Hirtle** (Hirtle & Co.): Bonds cheap relative to stocks at current valuations (10-year at 4.60% vs 2.20% breakeven inflation); investors should prepare portfolios for either bond rally or equity correction

Stocks & sectors discussed

Tech selloff led by semiconductors (SOX -4.5%, fourth straight decline); Meta down ninth consecutive session (longest since 2012 IPO); Ford +4% after hours on raised guidance; Visa -1.5% despite beat; Barnes & Noble pursuing store expansion (60 new locations annually) as physical bookstores see resurgence; Databricks seeing 80% consumption growth as enterprises adopt multi-model AI strategies.

"The problem is no one knows what they are going to make or who will buy the products. I think the uncertainty investors feel is maybe these companies have collectively over-invested." — Aswath Damodaran, NYU Stern Professor of Finance, on hyperscaler AI spending

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
Itron, Inc. (ITRI)	107.02	+26.23%
Ionic Digital Inc. Class A Common Stock (IOND)	62.90	+25.80%
Kiniksa Pharmaceuticals Interna (KNSA)	79.44	+25.03%
Lucid Group, Inc. (LCID)	7.90	+21.54%
IQVIA Holdings, Inc. (IQV)	242.94	+13.94%

Top News

Seagate’s earnings are welcome news for the battered AI trade — MarketWatch (Top)

The storage maker's June-quarter results come in ahead of Wall Street's expectations, and the stock rallies after hours

Meta likely to highlight smart glasses, avoid social media policy on upcoming earnings call, Kalshi traders say — CNBC (Finance)

The Facebook and Instagram owner is set to report earnings after the market close on Wednesday.

S&P upgrades AMC Entertainment rating on strong box office — Investing.com

Micron’s stock sinks toward worst monthly drop in 11 years as China fears escalate — MarketWatch (Top)

Investors are worried about China's domestic supply of chips and manufacturing tools, analysts noted.

The future of Wall Street is here as startups and brokers build AI agents to trade 24/7 — CNBC (Finance)

Brokerages, startups and even retail investors are building AI agents that can help oversee portfolios and automate investing tasks once handled by humans.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,428.78	+15.60	+0.21%
Nasdaq 100	27,763.13	-276.08	-0.98%
Dow Jones	52,747.32	+537.24	+1.03%
Russell 2000	2,953.80	+5.77	+0.20%
VIX	18.21	-0.46	-2.46%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	197.01	+0.50	+0.25%
Microsoft	393.35	+4.25	+1.09%
AMD	454.62	-40.33	-8.15%
Meta	593.41	-0.46	-0.08%
Alphabet	332.60	+6.03	+1.85%
Broadcom	380.91	-2.31	-0.60%
Micron	820.53	-79.67	-8.85%
Intel	86.30	-5.37	-5.86%
SanDisk	1,096.10	-182.13	-14.25%
Coherent	243.33	-27.98	-10.31%
Amazon	230.86	-0.53	-0.23%
Apple	340.08	+3.17	+0.94%
Arm	244.74	-21.59	-8.11%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,017.00	-21.70	-0.54%
Crude Oil	82.52	+3.26	+4.11%
Bitcoin	63,755.83	+585.36	+0.93%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.14	-0.00	-0.02%
USD/JPY	163.72	-0.09	-0.06%
GBP/USD	1.33	-0.00	-0.02%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.60	-0.04	-0.80%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.76	-0.04	-0.97%

Analyst Summary

Market Overview

U.S. equity markets delivered a split session on July 29, 2026, with the Dow Jones surging 1.03% while the Nasdaq 100 slipped 0.98%, flirting with correction territory at nearly 10% below recent highs. The S&P 500 eked out a modest 0.21% gain, masking significant sector divergence as investors continued to rotate away from technology into defensive and cyclical names. The VIX declined 2.46% to 18.21, suggesting orderly repositioning rather than panic.

Semiconductor Rout Intensifies

The Philadelphia Semiconductor Index extended its selloff for a fourth consecutive session, with memory and networking stocks bearing the brunt. **Micron plummeted 8.85%** amid escalating China concerns and what MarketWatch described as its worst monthly performance in 11 years. **AMD dropped 8.15%, Intel fell 5.86%, and Arm declined 8.11%.** The damage was particularly severe in memory and storage: **SanDisk crashed 14.25%** (down nearly 60% from recent highs), while networking names also suffered steep losses. Reddit's r/wallstreetbets captured the mood with dark humor about "short-term memory loss" and warnings to "never trust Jensen Huang."

Seagate's strong earnings—highlighting robust AI-driven data storage demand—offered little relief to the broader chip complex. Positioning data showed relatively low put-to-call ratios in semiconductors (0.59) and networking (0.53), suggesting the decline proceeded without significant hedging demand and that flows remain orderly rather than panicked.

Defensive Rotation and Standout Gainers

Investors piled into healthcare and consumer sectors, which rose 2.14% and 1.87% respectively with 100% and 69% breadth. The equal-weight S&P 500 outperformed its cap-weighted counterpart by roughly 90 basis points, underscoring broad market participation beyond mega-caps.

Top individual gainers reflected this shift: **Itron (ITRI) surged 26.23%, Ionic Digital (IOND) jumped 25.80%, Kiniksa Pharmaceuticals (KNSA) climbed 25.03%, Lucid Group (LCID) rallied 21.54%, and IQVIA (IQV) advanced 13.94%.** Consumer bellwethers delivered strong earnings, with Ford and Coca-Cola raising guidance.

Fed Decision and Cross-Asset Signals

With the Federal Reserve decision looming, markets priced a 30% probability of a rate hike Wednesday, rising to 60-70% for September. The 10-year Treasury yield declined 4 basis points to 4.60%, while crude oil rallied 4.11% to \$82.52 amid reports of Houthi strikes on Saudi tankers. Bitcoin gained 0.93%, and gold dipped modestly.

Notably, MarketWatch highlighted that the Bank of Japan's upcoming decision may matter more for portfolios than the Fed's, as South Korea's KOSPI plunged 8% with circuit breakers triggered—a reminder of growing stress in Asian markets. The combination of falling yields, rising oil, and tech weakness suggests markets are recalibrating growth expectations and bracing for potential monetary policy shifts on multiple fronts.